

We three kings

Text: John H. Hopkins Jr., 1857

Music: John H. Hopkins Jr., 1857

KINGS OF ORIENT 88.446 with refrain

The musical score is written for a single voice part in 6/8 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a clear refrain. The lyrics are arranged in five lines, with the first line being the main text and the subsequent lines being the refrain. The music is divided into four measures per line, with the first measure of each line containing the first line of text and the subsequent measures containing the refrain. The lyrics are: 1 We three kings of O - ri - ent are; bear - ing gifts we tra - verse a - far, 2 Born a King on Beth - le - hem's plain, gold I bring to crown him a - gain, 3 Frank - in - cense to of - fer have I; in - cense owns a de - i - ty nigh; 4 Myrrh is mine; its bit - ter per - fume breathes a life of gath - er - ing gloom; 5 Glo - rious now be - hold him a - rise; King and God and sac - ri - fice: field and foun - tain, moor and moun - tain, fol - low - ing yon - der star. King for - ev - er, ceas - ing nev - er, o - ver us all to reign. prayer and prais - ing, voic - es rais - ing, wor - ship - ing God on high. sor - rowing, sigh - ing, bleed - ing, dy - ing, sealed in the stone - cold tomb. Al - le - lu - ia, Al - le - lu - ia, sounds through the earth and skies. O star of won - der, star of light, star with roy - al beau - ty bright, west - ward lead - ing still pro - ceed - ing, guide us to thy per - fect light.

Fm C7 Fm C7 Fm

1 We three kings of O - ri - ent are; bear - ing gifts we tra - verse a - far,
2 Born a King on Beth - le - hem's plain, gold I bring to crown him a - gain,
3 Frank - in - cense to of - fer have I; in - cense owns a de - i - ty nigh;
4 Myrrh is mine; its bit - ter per - fume breathes a life of gath - er - ing gloom;
5 Glo - rious now be - hold him a - rise; King and God and sac - ri - fice:

Fm E♭ A♭ B♭m Fm C Fm

1 field and foun - tain, moor and moun - tain, fol - low - ing yon - der star.
2 King for - ev - er, ceas - ing nev - er, o - ver us all to reign.
3 prayer and prais - ing, voic - es rais - ing, wor - ship - ing God on high.
4 sor - rowing, sigh - ing, bleed - ing, dy - ing, sealed in the stone - cold tomb.
5 Al - le - lu - ia, Al - le - lu - ia, sounds through the earth and skies.

E♭ A♭ D♭ A♭ Fm D♭ A♭

O star of won - der, star of light, star with roy - al beau - ty bright,

Fm E♭ A♭ D♭ A♭ E♭sus E♭ A♭ D♭ A♭

west - ward lead - ing still pro - ceed - ing, guide us to thy per - fect light.